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DIGITAL LITERACY

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Introduction

This project focuses on understanding digital literacy in the context of how students use digital tools and online platforms in their daily lives. Today, students regularly use platforms for communication, collaboration, and building a professional presence. However, there is often a gap between simply using these tools and truly understanding their impact, risks, and responsibilities.

The scenario highlights how students may appear digitally skilled but may lack deeper awareness of issues such as online safety, ethical behavior, and long-term consequences of their actions. This project aims to explore these aspects by analyzing digital presence, collaboration practices, cyber awareness, and communication in digital spaces.

Overall, the objective is to move beyond basic usage and develop a more thoughtful and responsible approach to participating in the digital world.

Task 1: Project Report

For creating my visual resource, I used Canva because it provides easy-to-use templates and design elements suitable for making clean and professional infographics. My design focuses on explaining the concept of digital literacy in a simple and visually engaging way. It highlights key areas such as what digital literacy means, basic safe internet practices, maintaining a professional online presence, and proper email etiquette. I used minimal text along with icons and clear headings so that the information can be quickly understood at a glance.

The main aim of my design is to make students aware that digital literacy is not just about using technology, but also about being responsible and thoughtful in digital spaces. It encourages safe behavior, better communication, and a more professional approach online.

One challenge I faced while creating the design was reducing the content. There was a lot of information to include, but fitting it into a single poster without making it look crowded was difficult. However, it was interesting to see how simplifying content actually made the message clearer and more effective.

Task 2 : Project Report

For this task, I created profiles on LinkedIn, GitHub, and Stack Overflow, as each platform serves a different purpose in a student's learning and professional journey.

LinkedIn is mainly used for building a professional identity, connecting with peers and professionals, and showcasing achievements, skills, and projects. GitHub is used to store, manage, and share coding projects, which helps in building a strong technical portfolio. Stack Overflow is a platform where students can ask questions, find solutions to coding problems, and learn from a global developer community.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use these platforms to support my growth. I will regularly update my GitHub with projects to demonstrate my skills, use Stack Overflow to improve problem-solving by both asking and answering questions, and maintain my LinkedIn profile by adding achievements, certifications, and networking with professionals. Together, these platforms will help me build both technical skills and a strong professional presence for future opportunities.

Task 3: form report

For this task, I used platforms such as GitHub, Stack Overflow, and LinkedIn to build and practice my digital skills. On GitHub, I worked on uploading and managing basic coding projects, which helped me understand version control and how to organize my work properly. On Stack Overflow, I explored solutions to programming problems and learned how to ask questions clearly, which improved my problem-solving approach. LinkedIn was used to create a professional profile and showcase my skills, achievements, and interests.

Through these platforms, I practiced not only technical skills but also communication and presentation skills. They helped me understand how to represent my work in a structured and professional way.

Academically, these tools will be very useful over time. GitHub will help me maintain a record of my projects, Stack Overflow will support continuous learning through community interaction, and LinkedIn will help me stay connected with opportunities and professional growth. Overall, these platforms will strengthen both my learning process and future career readiness.

Task 4 : Project Report

A common example of poor digital communication is when a student sends an unclear or informal email to a professor regarding an important issue, such as assignment submission. For instance, writing a message like “Hey, I can’t submit, extend pls” without proper context or respect can create misunderstanding and may even be ignored. This can lead to missed deadlines or loss of marks.

The problem arises not just from the request itself, but from the lack of clarity, professionalism, and tone. The professor may not understand the urgency or reason behind the request.

This situation could have been handled better by writing a clear and polite email, including a proper subject line, explanation of the issue, and a respectful tone. Effective digital communication ensures that the message is understood correctly and increases the chances of a positive response.

Task 5:Project Report

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how easily cybercrimes succeed not because of advanced technology, but because of simple human mistakes. I realized that even basic actions like clicking on a link without checking or sharing small pieces of information can lead to serious consequences. I had assumed that being generally aware of online risks was enough, but I now understand that awareness does not always translate into careful behavior.

One habit I will personally change is being more cautious before taking any action online, especially when it involves links, messages, or financial transactions. I will make it a point to verify sources, double-check URLs, and avoid acting in a hurry. This small change can significantly reduce the chances of falling victim to scams and improve my overall digital safety.

Conclusion

This project shows that digital literacy is more than just using online tools; it involves understanding their impact, risks, and responsibilities. While digital platforms offer opportunities for learning, collaboration, and career growth, they also require careful and ethical use. The analysis highlights that awareness alone is not enough, as behavior and decision-making play a key role in preventing issues like cybercrime and miscommunication. Overall, the project emphasizes the importance of being responsible, cautious, and professional in digital spaces. Developing these habits will help students not only succeed academically but also prepare for future challenges in an increasingly digital world.

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